



# Basics

Getting to know the basics is key to mastering Linux programming.

## Introduction

Linux is an OS just like Windows and Mac OS X, but this one is an operating system's kernel. What do you mean by that? Linux is different from other popular operating systems as it is an open-source clone of the erstwhile UNIX. This means that Linux is free to use and you can make as many changes to personalise it and make it work according to you. That's not all, being open-source means there are several distributions or "distros" of Linux available for free. Some of the popular ones include Red Hat, Linux Ubuntu, Linux Mint, Debian and Fedora. Linux is mainly used in building internet servers, and almost 90% of the internet is based on Linux itself. The main reason behind the same is that Linux is free, easy to manipulate and secure.

This chapter will introduce you with the basics of all important Linux operating systems and guide you to some basic Linux operations like Navigating the Linux File System, Listing Directories, Working with the command, etc.